



do, choose limewash over cement paint. It breathes. It stays cooler. It does not release chemicals into your rooms for months afterwards. We used it on Indian walls for centuries before we quietly forgot about it.

Rainwater and Solar Retrofits

When you are ready to spend real money, spend it on where your water and power come from. If you have your own roof, the water falling on it every monsoon is worth more than you think. A rainwater filter fitted to your existing downpipe, the kind any local plumber can install in a day, cleans that runoff before it goes into a tank or back into the ground beneath your house. In a country where the same roof floods a street in July and a borewell runs dry in May; that is not a small thing. A solar water heater belongs in the same conversation and it is one of the few retrofits that genuinely pays for itself. If you cannot put panels on a shared roof, solar subscriptions now let you buy solar power without owning a single panel.

None of this will impress a visitor. Nobody notices a tap that uses less water or a terrace that has stopped baking. What you notice is smaller bills and rooms that stop fighting you every summer. You inherited this house exactly as somebody else left it. What it becomes from here is the one part that was always yours.